

Lipfty

Printable rules - Lipfty 10 development edition

Board and pieces

Lipfty is played on a physical 8x8 board. Only the inner 6x6 is active. The 32 pieces are shared rather than owned by either player.

Four opening anchors are placed automatically on the four corners of the inner 6x6. Diagonally opposite anchors have matching colours. Anchors count towards wins, but are permanently pinned: they cannot Move, cannot Jump and cannot be jumped over.

There are 24 normal reserve pieces, 12 of each colour, plus four Final Four pieces.

Winning versions

Standard: four matching-colour pieces horizontally, vertically or diagonally.

Advanced: Standard wins plus a tight 2x2 square.

Extreme: Advanced wins plus a spaced, board-aligned square.

A permitted winning pattern ends the game immediately.

Normal turn

Your opponent chooses a normal reserve piece and hands it to you. While both reserve colours remain, you must use that colour to either **Place**, **Move** or **Jump**.

Place: place the handed reserve piece on any empty active square.

Move: move a movable board piece of the handed colour to an empty adjacent square, horizontally, vertically or diagonally.

Jump: jump one adjacent opposite-colour movable piece in a straight horizontal, vertical or diagonal line, landing on the empty square immediately beyond it. There are no multi-jumps.

A board piece that was moved on the immediately preceding turn is protected: it cannot Move or Jump on the next turn.

The held-piece rule

When you are handed a reserve piece, you keep hold of that exact piece until you place it yourself. It is never returned to reserve and is not passed back to the opponent.

Move consequence

After a non-winning Move, keep hold of your handed reserve piece. Choose a different available reserve piece for your opponent to place. If that placement does not win, you then place the piece you were originally handed. Your opponent then takes the next normal turn.

Jump consequence

After a non-winning Jump, keep hold of your handed reserve piece. Lift the exact jumped piece and give it to your opponent to redeploy on any empty active square. If that redeployment does not win, you then place the piece you were originally handed. Your opponent then takes the next normal turn.

One-colour finish and Final Four

As soon as only one normal reserve colour remains, Move and Jump stop. The remaining normal reserve pieces are placed one at a time until the reserve is empty. Any already-started consequence is completed first.

Then the Final Four phase begins. The four remaining corner pieces are placed one at a time, with no Move or Jump. If all Final Four pieces are placed without a win, the game is drawn.

Other rules

Wins are immediate whether made by a normal placement, Move, Jump, Jump redeployment, held-piece placement or Final Four placement.

Lipfty also supports Undo and an optional chess clock. The clock runs only for the player currently making a decision.